Biofouling is the accumulation of aquatic organisms such as microorganisms, plants and animals on surfaces and structures immersed in or exposed to the aquatic environment. Biofouling can include pathogens. For microfouling and macrofouling, see definitions below.

Biofouling pressure means the biofouling accumulation rate , which differs regionally and

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
Biofouling can include pathogens. For microfouling and macrofouling, see definitions below.

Biofouling pressure means the biofouling accumulation rate , which differs regionally and seasonally. High biofouling pressure means the development of dense biofouling within a short period of time.

Capture is the process of containment, collection and removal of biofouling material and waste substances detached from submerged surfaces during cleaning in water or in dry dock.

Cleaning system is the equipment used for, or the process of, removal of biofouling from the ship surface, with or without capture.

Dry-dock cleaning refers to the cleaning of the submerged areas when the ship is out of water.

Fouling rating is the allocation of a number for a defined inspection area of the ship surface based on a visual assessment, including description of biofouling present and percentage of macrofouling coverage.

In-water cleaning is the removal of biofouling from a ship's hull and niche areas while in the water.

Invasive aquatic species are non-native species to a particular ecosystem which may pose

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
macrofouling coverage.

In-water cleaning is the removal of biofouling from a ship's hull and niche areas while in the water.

Invasive aquatic species are non-native species to a particular ecosystem which may pose threats to human, animal and plant life, economic and cultural activities and the aquatic environment.

Macrofouling is biofouling caused by the attachment and subsequent growth of visible plants and animals on structures and ships exposed to water. Macrofouling is large, distinct multicellular individual or colonial organisms visible to the human eye such as barnacles, tubeworms, mussels, fronds/filaments of algae, bryozoans, sea squirts and other large attached, encrusting or mobile organisms.

Marine growth prevention system (MGPS) is an AFS used for the prevention of biofouling accumulation in niche areas or other surface areas but may also include methods which apply

surface treatments.

Member States means States that are Members of the International Maritime Organization.

Microfouling is biofouling caused by bacteria, fungi, microalgae, protozoans and other microscopic organisms that creates a biofilm also called a slime layer.

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
Microfouling is biofouling caused by bacteria, fungi, microalgae, protozoans and other microscopic organisms that creates a biofilm also called a slime layer.

Niche areas are a subset of the submerged surface areas on a ship that may be more susceptible to biofouling than the main hull owing to structural complexity, different or variable hydrodynamic forces, susceptibility to AFC wear or damage, or inadequate or no protection by AFS.

Organization means the International Maritime Organization.

Port State authority means any official or organization authorized by the Government of a port State to verify the compliance and enforcement of standards and regulations relevant to the implementation of national and international shipping control measures.

Proactive cleaning is the periodic removal of microfouling on ships' hulls to prevent or minimize attachment of macrofouling.

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
the implementation of national and international shipping control measures.

Proactive cleaning is the periodic removal of microfouling on ships' hulls to prevent or minimize attachment of macrofouling.

Reactive cleaning is a corrective action during which biofouling is removed from a ship's hull and niche areas either in water with capture or in dry dock.

Ship means a vessel of any type whatsoever operating in the aquatic environment and includes hydrofoil boats, air -cushion vehicles, submersibles, floating craft, fixed or floating platforms, floating storage units and floating production storage and off-loading units.

States means coastal, port, flag or Member States, as appropriate.

Waste substances are dissolved and particulate materials that may be released or produced during cleaning or maintenance, and may include biocides, metals, organic substances, removed biofouling, pigments, microplastics or other contaminants that could have a negative

impact on the environment.

3 APPLICATION

3.1 The Guidelines are intended to provide useful recommendations for measures to

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
removed biofouling, pigments, microplastics or other contaminants that could have a negative impact on the environment.

3 APPLICATION

3.1 The Guidelines are intended to provide useful recommendations for measures to minimize biofouling for all types of ships. The Guidelines are directed at various stakeholders, such as ship designers, shipbuilders, anti -fouling paint manufacturers and su ppliers, States, including environmental and regulatory agencies, classification societies, shipowners, ship operators, charterers, shipmasters, port authorities, ship cleaning and maintenance operators, inspection organizations, ship repair, dry -docking a nd recycling facilities, and any other interested parties.

3.2 Alternative procedures, methods or actions taken to meet the objectives of these Guidelines which are not described should be reported to the Organization by Members of the Organization and their representatives and be taken into account in future revi ews of the Guidelines as appropriate.

3.3 A separate guidance document, based on these Guidelines, provides advice relevant

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf
Organization and their representatives and be taken into account in future revi ews of the Guidelines as appropriate.

3.3 A separate guidance document, based on these Guidelines, provides advice relevant to owners and/or operators of recreational craft less than 24 metres in length, using terminology appropriate for that sector (Guidance for minimizing the transfer of invasive aquatic species as biofouling (hull fouling) for recreational craft (MEPC.1/Circ.792)).

3.4 The Guidelines may not be relevant to ships which operate only in the same waters in which the biofouling was accumulated. Although operation in the same waters leads to no risk of introducing invasive aquatic species, measures to avoid discharge of harmful waste substances during cleaning may still be relevant.

3.5 An inspection regime as defined in paragraphs 8.4 to 8.6 may not be relevant to a

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SOURCE: MEPC.378(80).pdf

3.5 An inspection regime as defined in paragraphs 8.4 to 8.6 may not be relevant to a ship when idle for a longer period. To maintain the anti-fouling effect of an AFS, inspection and reactive cleaning may be needed before the ship is reactivated to reduce the risk of biofouling.

4 OBJECTIVES

4.1 The objective of these Guidelines is to minimize the transfer of invasive aquatic species through biofouling on ships.

4.2 Procedures, methods and actions taken in line with these Guidelines should safeguard the obligation under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS), article 194, to prevent, reduce and control pollution of the marine environment. This includes ensuring not to transfer, directly or indirectly, damage or hazards from one area to another, or transform one type of pollution into another (ref. UNCLOS article 195), as well as preventing the intentional or accidental introduction of species, alien or new, to a particular